



Intimate Care Policy

SECTIONS 1-3: PURPOSE, SCOPE & PRINCIPLES

1 PURPOSE

This policy ensures that all intimate care provided to residents of Chosanta Management is delivered in a manner that protects dignity, privacy, independence, and wellbeing.

- ✓ Personal hygiene
- ✓ Continence care
- ✓ Dressing and undressing
- ✓ Menstrual care
- ✓ Support with eating or drinking if required

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All staff involved in providing or supporting residents with any form of intimate care
- ✓ Residents of all genders and ages with personal care needs
- ✓ One-to-one and assisted care delivery; use of continence aids and bathing equipment
- ✓ Respecting gender, cultural, and religious sensitivities
- ✓ Situations involving consent, risk, and protection from abuse

3 PRINCIPLES OF INTIMATE CARE

- ✓ **Dignity & Respect:** Every resident has the right to privacy and dignity at all times
- ✓ **Consent & Choice:** Care only provided with consent; residents supported to express preferences
- ✓ **Independence:** Residents encouraged to carry out aspects of care themselves where possible
- ✓ **Safety:** Practices follow infection control standards and are risk-assessed
- ✓ **Communication:** Staff explain procedures and ensure residents are comfortable and informed
- ✓ **Gender Sensitivity:** Resident requests regarding carer gender respected where feasible
- ✓ **Professionalism:** Staff conduct with discretion, empathy, and awareness of boundaries

Intimate Care Policy

SECTIONS 4-6: CONSENT, STAFF PRACTICE & PRIVACY

4 CONSENT

- ✓ Verbal or non-verbal consent sought before each instance of intimate care
- ✓ Resident's right to refuse or withdraw consent respected at any time
- ✓ Individuals supported to communicate consent in their preferred method (gestures, signs, assistive devices)
- ✓ Where capacity is in question, formal capacity assessment carried out under the Assisted Decision-Making (Capacity) Act 2015
- ✓ Consent documented clearly in personal care plans and reviewed regularly

5 STAFF PRACTICE

- ✓ Explain each step and check consent before proceeding
- ✓ Ensure privacy — close doors, use screens, limit exposure
- ✓ Use gloves, aprons, and appropriate PPE for hygiene
- ✓ Use soft tone, calm manner, and respectful language
- ✓ Encourage independence; never rush or pressure a resident
- ✓ Report any unusual findings (bruising, skin changes) immediately
- ✓ Document care provided clearly and factually
- ✓ Maintain professional boundaries at all times

6 PRIVACY & DIGNITY

- ✓ Care provided in private spaces with minimal interruptions
- ✓ Knock before entering and explain intentions clearly
- ✓ Cover the resident appropriately; expose only what is necessary
- ✓ Allow residents time to respond, participate, or ask questions
- ✓ Accommodate cultural and personal preferences regarding gender and routines

Intimate Care Policy

SECTIONS 7–10: RECORDS, SAFEGUARDING, TRAINING & REVIEW

7 RECORD KEEPING

- ✓ Record each instance of intimate care in daily care notes — time, nature, and observations
- ✓ Report any concerns, injuries, refusals, or unusual findings to PIC immediately
- ✓ Use objective, factual, and respectful language in all entries
- ✓ Records stored securely; accessible only to authorised personnel (GDPR & HIQA compliant)

8 SAFEGUARDING & REPORTING CONCERNS

- ✓ Report concerns, disclosures, or suspicions immediately to the DLP or PIC
- ✓ Document concerns factually and confidentially
- ✓ Follow safeguarding policy and Children First / National Safeguarding guidelines
- ✓ Protect resident from further harm while concern is being addressed
- ✓ Cooperate fully with investigations; ensure resident has access to advocacy and support

9 TRAINING

- ✓ Intimate care procedures and personal care planning
- ✓ Infection prevention and control
- ✓ Safeguarding vulnerable adults and children
- ✓ Consent, dignity, and communication in care
- ✓ Recognising and responding to distress, refusal, or changes in behaviour
- ✓ Refresher training provided annually or as required

10 POLICY REVIEW

- ✓ Reviewed annually or sooner if changes in legislation, HIQA standards, or practice
- ✓ Feedback from residents, staff, and advocates incorporated
- ✓ Review of incident reports and practice audits informs revisions
- ✓ Oversight by the Registered Provider and Person in Charge
- ✓ Revised versions communicated to staff and made available in appropriate formats